

Arts Excursions Unlimited

Executive Summary

Client

Edith Abeyta

Student Consulting Team

Lisa Huang

Aaron HuSun

Ismael Garudo

Background

Arts Excursions Unlimited (AEU) is a grassroots, community-based arts organization founded in 2015 in the Hazelwood neighborhood of Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania. Its mission is to expand access to arts and cultural experiences while fostering community engagement and civic participation. AEU serves local residents of all ages through free or low-cost excursions, public art projects, and neighborhood programming. The organization operates with limited resources, relying on a single primary maintainer and simple technology tools such as WordPress, email, and phone communication. Prior to this project, AEU's digital presence did not effectively reflect its active programming or community impact.

Project Description

Project Opportunity

AEU's website functioned primarily as an outdated, static record rather than a dynamic communication tool. Event information was not centralized online, archival media was fragmented, and maintaining the site required time and technical effort that competed with core community work. This created barriers for community members trying to access information, limited AEU's ability to showcase its impact to funders and partners, and placed a disproportionate administrative burden on the director.

Project Vision

The project aimed to transform AEU's website into a sustainable, easy-to-maintain digital hub that reflects the organization's ongoing activity and community presence. Rather than rebuilding from scratch, the solution focused on restructuring the existing WordPress site to prioritize simplicity, accessibility, and long-term independence through a structured events workflow, a categorized media archive, and a documentation package enabling independent maintenance. The goal was to make maintaining the website intuitive and efficient, so that keeping it updated became a natural part of AEU's workflow.

Project Outcomes

The project delivered four key outcomes: a redesigned public-facing website, a structured event publishing system, a categorized media archive, and a comprehensive documentation and training package.

From a people perspective, community members can now easily discover events, engage with AEU's work, and see themselves represented through visual storytelling. Edith, the director, can independently manage all website updates without technical support.

From a process perspective, routine tasks such as posting events, updating pages, and uploading photos have been streamlined into simple, repeatable workflows that Edith completed in under five minutes each during her first independent session, from memory and without consulting documentation.

From a technology perspective, the solution leverages AEU's existing WordPress platform with minimal plugins, ensuring low cost, ease of maintenance, and long-term sustainability.

Together, these outcomes shift the website from a dormant asset to an active tool that supports outreach, storytelling, and operational efficiency.

Project Deliverables

The operational deliverables handed off to AEU include the redesigned WordPress website, structured workflows for event publishing and media management, an archive of images, and a complete documentation and training package with written guides and recorded video walkthroughs. Supporting archival materials — wireframes, logo iterations, research findings, sprint reports, meeting notes, and proposal documents — are preserved in the shared project repository for future reference. Together these deliverables ensure that AEU has both the technical system and the knowledge required to maintain and extend the site independently.

Recommendations

Recommendations for AEU include maintaining a regular content update schedule, tagging archive photos consistently at upload time, training additional community members to share maintenance responsibilities, implementing routine automated website backups, and using the website as the central hub for all outreach efforts. For future student teams or contractors, opportunities include adding an AI-powered chatbot for visitor questions, integrating live social media feeds into the site, and conducting an accessibility audit to further enhance usability and inclusivity.

Student Consulting Team

Lisa Huang served as the team's Quality Assurance Manager, focusing on style consistency and overall quality control. She is a third-year student majoring in Information Systems and Artificial Intelligence. This coming summer, she will be interning at Google as a software engineer. Her primary focus in this project was WordPress development and maintainer enablement.

Aaron HuSun was the team's Client Relationship Manager, focusing on coordinating meetings and post-effort logistics with the client. He is a third-year student majoring in Information Systems with a minor in Computer Science and is looking forward to joining Meta as a SWE Intern in Summer 2026.

Ismael Garudo served as the team's Project Manager, acting as the spokesperson and leader. He is a fourth-year student majoring in Information Systems and is returning to PwC as a consultant in the Deals Technology practice after graduation. He focused on developing wireframes and website designs.